

Anchoring the Future

How Paradip Port Is Redefining India's Maritime Frontier

Paradip Port has quietly transformed into the powerhouse of India's eastern seaboard—an engine of efficiency, innovation, and green growth. In just a few years, it has evolved from a strong regional gateway into the nation's top-performing major port, setting new records in cargo handling, rail evacuation, and turnaround speed. In this exclusive Q&A with Shri P.L. Harnadh, Chairman, Paradip Port Authority, we explore how a mix of operational excellence, capacity expansion, and sustainability vision is propelling Paradip Port 2.0 and redefining the maritime future of India's East Coast.



Sh. P L Haranadh
Chairman
Paradip Port Authority

Q1. Paradip Port is India's leading major port. What key attributes have driven this success?
In FY 2024–25, Paradip's leadership as India's No. 1 cargo-handling major port was driven by three decisive factors: high operational efficiency on the waterfront, strong rail-led evacuation capacity, and continuous system and process improvements in partnership with stakeholders. This operating model helped us handle 150.41 MMT, achieve record rail evacuation of 22,818 rakes (81.01 MMT rail-borne), and sustain berth productivity of 34,283 MT/day/berth, highest among all major ports with nearly twice the national average . We have sustained this momentum into FY 2025–26—with one month still remaining, the port has already handled 142.3 MMT (Apr'25–Feb'26), registering a 6 MMT increase over the corresponding period last year, and achieving a new January record of 14.44 MMT, reflecting steady capacity and coordination gains.

Q2 Could you share updates on major capacity-creation projects (new berths, mechanisation, Western Dock/other expansions) and how they will improve throughput and vessel turnaround?
Paradip Port's capacity expansion programme is focused on creating new capacity while simultaneously improving efficiency, evacuation strength and cargo diversification. Our flagship project is the 25 MTPA Western Dock, progressing steadily and targeted for completion by end of 2026, almost $1^{1/2}$ year ahead of target, thus setting a benchmark in project execution. This project will enable cape vessel handling capacity to offer economies of scale to the customers.

In parallel, we are mechanising existing four semi-mechanised berths and taking up the addition of four new berths to raise throughput and reduce handling constraints. We are also developing a dedicated green berth to support the export ecosystem for green hydrogen and green ammonia, aligned with India's clean energy vision.

In terms of performance outcomes, Paradip already operates at a competitive turnaround benchmark: our average turnaround of vessels in FY 2024–25 was 39.09 hours, significantly better than several comparable Indian ports and broadly aligned with key international median benchmarks.

Q3 How is Paradip implementing Harit Sagar / decarbonisation—renewable energy, electrification, green equipment, shore power, and waste/water sustainability?
On renewable energy, we have already rooftop solar panels, while a 10 MW ground-mounted solar plant is targeted for commissioning by June 2026 and the 2nd 10 MW slated for March 2027. We are accelerating electrification and cleaner mobility—rail electrification and safety interlocking have been completed, EV/hybrid induction and hydrogen-run buses are being planned for internal mobility.

For marine operations, green tug procurement has been initiated, and we are targeting induction of 50% green pilot/mooring boats. Shore-to-ship power has been enabled for small tugs, port craft and coastal vessels at CB1/CB2, with expansion to EXIM berths planned. We are also preparing Paradip for future green fuels through the green hydrogen/green ammonia export ecosystem, including a 4 MTPA dedicated berth.

Alongside decarbonisation, we are strengthening sustainability fundamentals—5 lakh trees planted since 2021 with a target of 1 million trees by Jun'26, energy efficiency through LED conversion, and water sustainability through three STPs (6.5 MLD) with treated water reused for dust suppression and gardening.

Q4 What does "Paradip Port 2.0" mean in practical terms, and what are the key milestones over the next 3–5 years?
"Paradip Port 2.0" means scaling from a high-performing cargo gateway into a full-spectrum maritime ecosystem for Odisha and the East Coast—spanning new ports, shipbuilding, cruise, industrial clusters and multimodal logistics, all aligned with national corridors. In practical terms, the next 3–5 years are anchored around execution of the two landmark MoUs signed with the Government of Odisha—Bahuda Major Port and the shipbuilding/ship-repair hub at the Mahanadi mouth—with a combined investment intent of ₹46,200 crore.

The Satellite Major Port at Bahuda Muhana in Ganjam district, Odisha, is envisioned as a greenfield major port with a capacity of 150 MTPA and an estimated investment of about ₹21,500 crore. It is expected to create a new deep-draft gateway, unlock coastal and hinterland trade, and help decongest existing gateways.

Secondly, the proposed shipbuilding and ship-repair complex at Mahanadi river mouth in Kendrapada District, Odisha, with an estimated investment of about ₹24,700 crore, will establish a strategic manufacturing and maintenance base on the east coast. This initiative is aligned with India's push to strengthen its shipbuilding capabilities.